

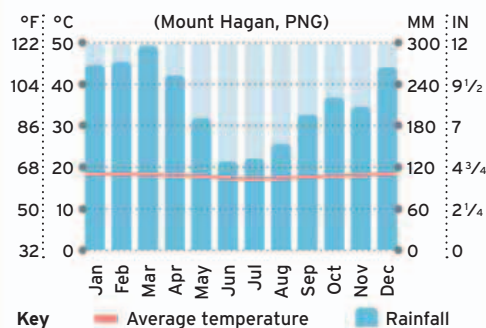
LOCATION

New Guinea's montane rainforests run west to east at altitudes of 3,280–9,840 ft (1,000–3,000 m), mainly along the Central Ranges.



CLIMATE

Significant rain falls every month. Temperatures hardly vary through the year, but are highly affected by the cooling effect of altitude.



Common spotted cuscus

Spilocuscus maculatus

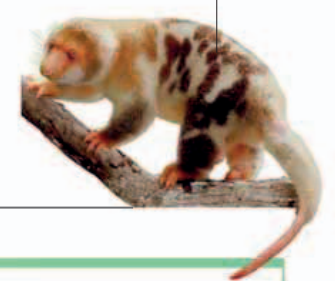
A mainly nocturnal, tree-living marsupial, the common spotted cuscus has a woolly pelt that is prized by hunters, who also kill it for its meat. The cuscus sleeps on branches with its head tucked between its legs, often pulling large leaves around itself to hide from predators.

▷ TELLING TAIL

As well as its five-toed feet, the cuscus climbs with its prehensile tail—the lower half is naked on the inside to better grip branches.



male's coat more spotted and patched than female's



- ↔ 14–18 in (36–45 cm)
- ⚖ 3–8 lb (1.4–3.6 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Fruit, flowers, leaves
- 🏠



Papua New Guinea, N. Australia

Long-beaked echidna

Zaglossus bartoni

Protective white spines cover the eastern long-beaked echidna's head, back, and sides, but are almost hidden beneath its coarse, dark fur. This species is the largest of the monotremes, the group of egg-laying mammals that also includes the duck-billed platypus. Males have hind ankle spurs, and both female and male long-beaked echidnas use the electroreceptors in their snout to detect their prey's electric fields.

▽ WORM HUNTER

When foraging for earthworms, echidnas probe the soil with their long snout. They grasp the worms with their tongue, which has a spinelike structure at the back.

- ↔ 24–39 in (61–100 cm)
- ⚖ 11–22 lb (5–10 kg)
- ⊗ Critically endangered
- 🌿 Earthworms
- 🏠



New Guinea



RARE BUTTERFLY

New Guinea has a diverse array of birdwings, or large swallowtail butterflies. The rare Rothschild's birdwing, which has a wingspan of 6–7 in (15–18 cm), is found only at 8,200 ft (2,500 m) in the Doberai Peninsula.

World's highest island

ROTHSCHILD'S BIRDWING

